

to time till the disc is full. Once that happens no further write sessions will be supported. There is also the added option to delete previous sessions on +R discs but this won't allow you to re-record onto the deleted portions, so the deleted space is deemed lost forever.

4. RW – this indicates that the disc is re-recordable. So not only can you write in multiple sessions but you can rewrite over a deleted session. Depending upon the manufacturing process the number of times that they can be reused varies between 25-100 times. However, you should be thankful if you can manage to hit 25 since these are much prone to scratches compared to -R / +R discs.

What to buy

1. While CDs and DVDs aren't as economical as they used to be given the reducing prices of flash drives there still are plenty of reasons why one would need access to a CD / DVD ROM drive. But if you already have a laptop or PC with an disc drive, then you really wouldn't need another disc drive. Even operating systems which could only be installed via bootable CDs are now available as images which can be copied onto bootable flash drives.
2. A Blu-ray writer is not a necessity and will not be for a few more years to come, so you can simply settle for a player instead.

Portable storage drives

Moving data between different computers began with the use of punching cards, then progressed to different types of magnetic hard drives and floppy drives and has now finally come down to flash storage. So how far have we come in terms of durability and reliability while increasing storage space? Read on to find out.

Types

Portable hard drives

These are geared towards high capacities since they house traditional hard drives within a durable casing. While depending upon the power requirements you may find either a laptop hard drive which is smaller (2.5 inch) and consumes less power or a regular desktop hard drive (3.5 inch). The ones with desktop hard drives are not termed to be portable as they require much greater power than most interface ports like the USB or Firewire can